

Our humanity is needed.

AI is a threat, We are collateral damage.> Respect that it is an emotion.

Helping a person feel heard

UX is defining in terms of product/service

a serious study of AI consistency.

Validating the output is more work than performing the analysis without AI.

It is on user to fact check

Recommendation book: AI snake oil.

AI is Not intelligence but people are willing to believe it.

AutoCorrect the normative push.

Misconceptions the risk of making a cool diagram

Scientism versus scientific experimentation, it is another misconception

Book recommendation the service Berry.

The natural economy is circular the natural world give us models of how to leave a balanced and general generative way.

The things we do affect the world

Circular economy gift economy.

Better outcomes for people.

Plurality to go beyond our assumptions.

The value of talented employees

The magic dice under oppression

Giving talented employees anxiety and they can no longer work the magic

UX practice past and futures

We overdid it on our talent focus too much on advocating

James slang UX mag five June 2025 failure to define and own the value of UX research

We advocate for the user.

Profit Speed endless growth and nothing that is helping the user.

Understanding

Supporting human complexity and variety is valuable to orgs

Deepest listeners.

Cognitive empathy.

Not making assumptions

Model model skyline emerges via data synthesis

Thinking style describe care cognitive patterns people focus on their purpose.

Community equal feel seen

Working sessions out chance to be together in a constructive way

to feel threatened is an emotion

respect the emotion, don't try to take it away

empathic listening ("empathy") helping a person feel heard

- when they have "something going on" mentally or emotionally, negative or positive
- which lightens a negative, and reflects more broadly a positive

there are all sorts of "threats" to UX

AI	people's willingness to believe that models are "intelligent"
misconceptions	eg. reverse double diamond, qual is "bad" research
speed & efficiency	move fast & break things, Agile, "UX Feature Factory"
strategy not needed	see if it works, then try the next thing
product managers	trusted by leadership
KPIs & OKRs	mostly inward facing, not tracking outcomes for people
growth & profit	"endless" is not sustainable or natural economy

down the AI rabbit hole

Erika Hall (last week of May 2025)

"Let's put this whole synthetic users; thing to rest. It is unethical, indefensible, and also unnecessary, to create a product or service or policy that affects other people, without having conversations with representatives of those populations. And listening. And taking their concerns and lived reality into serious consideration. Not merely the intended users or customers, but the range of stakeholders.

The time and money argument is hot garbage. It's false economization for the purpose of avoiding

not "intelligence"

Arvind Narayanan & Sayash Kapoor AI Snake Oil newsletter, 15-Apr-2025

"De-emphasizing intelligence is not just a rhetorical move: We do not think there is a useful sense of the term 'intelligence' in which AI is more intelligent than people acting with the help of AI.

Human intelligence is special ... and cannot be coherently placed on a spectrum of intelligence."

<https://www.aisnakeoil.com/p/ai-as-normal-technology>

misconceptions the risk of making a cool diagram

The Traditional "Desianer Centri Dauble Diamond

someone posted last week:

"Let's use reverse double diamond with AI."

"scientism" vs scientific experimentation

another misconception

business wants to make decisions "scientifically"

assuming that "science" = facts, truth

business processes & thinking get set in stone but scientists are curiosity-driven, "huh, what if ...?"

* focused on continuing to build knowledge + changing earlier knowledge based on new discoveries,

sharing results and questions with the community

circular economy, gift economy

Steve Levitt, about market economy

"When the needs of the market don't align with the needs of people, we need to listen to the needs of humans and realign the market to do a better job of supporting human outcomes."

circular economy, gift economy

better outcomes for people give them ability to do	plurality
more (or rest more)	
	there are many ways of approaching the same
imagine your org's future always expanding, not	thing
always collapsing to one solution	
	examples:
your team can structure knowledge to allow	distribute seeds
	communicate an idea
unthought-of solutions to emerge	change personal identity
	decide what's for lunch
imagination & creativity use understanding of	take care of chronic
others around us, plurality, to go beyond our	condition
	decide to go out to a

assumptions	performance
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the magic dies under oppression
 give talented employees anxiety and they can no longer work the magic
 MAKE IT BETTER
 The chaos here inspires me to make it better. I want to be able to change the things that aren't working. I have ideas. I need to feel seen.
 STIFLED
 My work (or shift) is not what they promised. It feels like leaders are not being honest or treating me well. I've tried to make it work, but I have had enough.
 PROVE MYSELF
 I feel like I need to prove that I am productive and valuable. I will take up extra tasks, put in late hours, and hope my leaders will notice.
 YOU DON'T VALUE ME
 My leaders repeatedly pass me over, change plans, and ignore my achievements. I put my head down and bear with it. But I am discontent.
 four employee thinking styles at an org that is undergoing repeated layoffs
 created for managers to be able to better support the talent they have

we overdid it on our talent, though
 several people have pointed out that we focused too much on advocating for the user
 and not enough on using the research in collaboration with many different teams at our orgs, or connecting it with other data

we advocated for the user because fast-growth-capitalism feels icky how can we bring value they want?
 profit, speed, endless growth are not things that help users ...
 ... tends to harm them instead

MILD
 annoyance confusion dislike frustration
 worry
 words to talk about harm
 SERIOUS
 LASTING
 SYSTEMIC
 interruption. pestering
 unpaid labor wasted time self doubt
 misleading information emotional trigger shame

diminished reputation	

lost productivity	
lost work	
lost money	
lost relationships	
	vilification, hatred, rage
threat or attack	
injury or death	
inequality within:	
education	
healthcare	
housing	
opportunity	
salary	
arrest	
laws	

our community is User eXperience

... UX is defined in terms of the product, service, or system

with users trying to make it do something

what if we start with their something, and understand people's cognitive approaches to it? create better outcomes for their cognition

a structure for emergence, complexity imagination & creativity use

understanding of others around us, plurality, to go beyond our assumptions

mental model diagrams + thinking styles give us structured ways to grow the number of paths forward for your org

spotlight patterns of cognition that already exist in people's minds emergence, systems thinking, complexity

supporting human complexity & variety

is valuable to orgs ...

the future of business won't belong to the fast innovators, it will belong to the deepest listeners

understanding people's cognition as they already address their something ...

because humans are intelligent

orgs can escape the trap of collapsing to one average solution

innovating based off the most under-leveraged data set in enterprise strategy: cognitive empathy

cognition

cognitive empathy is:

g cultivating an understanding of a person's inner thinking,
emotional reactions, personal rules

O to understand their approach, without making assumptions © patterns
across people make it scalable for an organization, not one-on-one

the person tells their story

concept from the person's story so far

mental model skyline of people using the method

social crisis of not feeling seen

"If you are laid off, it's not personal."

this is a classic example of depersonalization (not feeling seen)

Allison J. Pugh says it's not a crisis of loneliness, but a crisis of
depersonalization in many societies

the technology mindset seems bent on further depersonalizing everything

community = feel seen

much of our work time is spent alone

commenting, reading articles, writing, programming, recording, playing with
data, listening to talks, scrolling through posts

it's not enough for our humanity

working sessions are a chance to be together in a constructive way

collaborate, feel part, feel seen